## Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills – Level 2

# ***Past Paper 4***

Time: 75 minutes | Paper Reference **PENR2/S04**

# English

## Component 2: Reading
## Text Booklet

**Do not return this Text Booklet with the Question and Answer Booklet.**

### Instructions

- You should write your answers in the Question and Answer Booklet.
- You must **not** write any responses to questions in this Text Booklet.

### Information

- This Text Booklet contains the three texts required for the Level 2 Component 2: Reading exam.
- This Text Booklet must be securely destroyed by the centre immediately after the exam has been completed.

### Advice

- Read each text before you answer the questions.

*Turn over* ▶

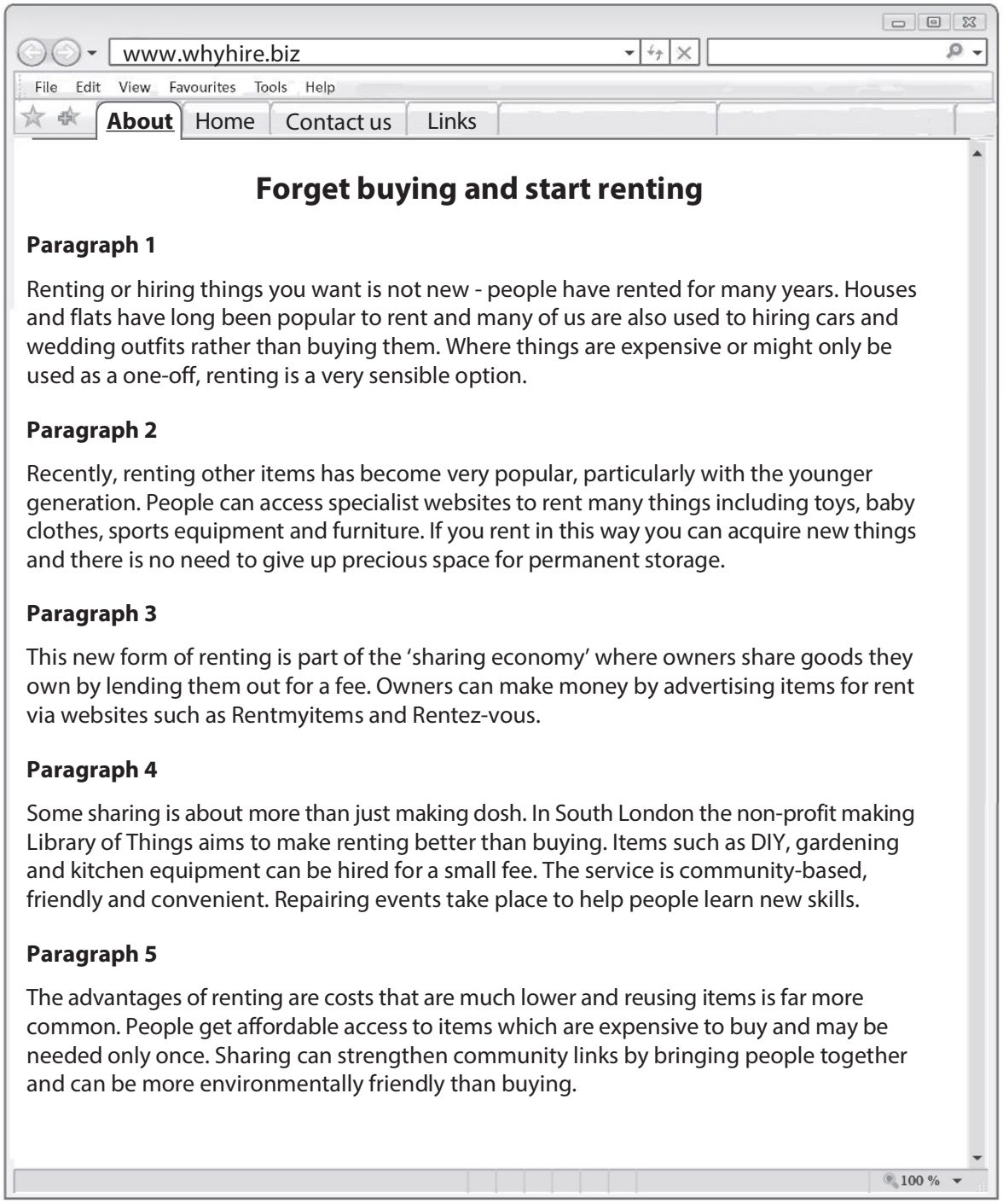

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**Text A**

**Webpage**




## Forget buying and start renting

**Paragraph 1**

Renting or hiring things you want is not new - people have rented for many years. Houses and flats have long been popular to rent and many of us are also used to hiring cars and wedding outfits rather than buying them. Where things are expensive or might only be used as a one-off, renting is a very sensible option.

**Paragraph 2**

Recently, renting other items has become very popular, particularly with the younger generation. People can access specialist websites to rent many things including toys, baby clothes, sports equipment and furniture. If you rent in this way you can acquire new things and there is no need to give up precious space for permanent storage.

**Paragraph 3**

This new form of renting is part of the 'sharing economy' where owners share goods they own by lending them out for a fee. Owners can make money by advertising items for rent via websites such as Rentmyitems and Rentez-vous.

**Paragraph 4**

Some sharing is about more than just making dosh. In South London the non-profit making Library of Things aims to make renting better than buying. Items such as DIY, gardening and kitchen equipment can be hired for a small fee. The service is community-based, friendly and convenient. Repairing events take place to help people learn new skills.

**Paragraph 5**

The advantages of renting are costs that are much lower and reusing items is far more common. People get affordable access to items which are expensive to buy and may be needed only once. Sharing can strengthen community links by bringing people together and can be more environmentally friendly than buying.

**Text B**

**Newspaper article**

# Sharing economy

**by Hannah Parry**

- People are now choosing to hire or rent rather than own goods.
- Everything from clothes and handbags to music is rented.
- Younger people are less materialistic than older people with 75% preferring experiences to things.

Many people are choosing to rent rather than buy. Teenagers and twenty-somethings are boosting the sharing economy and almost anything is available to rent. According to a report, those born after 2000 are much less materialistic than older people. Many young people think that having access to items is much more important than owning them. The sharing economy does not only benefit those who rent. Owners can make cash from their unused stuff.

In most sharing services, the lender posts their goods online and decides how much to charge for their items. Many people rent from clothes-borrowing sites such as Rentez-vous, Girl Meets Dress and My Dressing which are becoming more and more popular. They help owners to make cash from their cast-off clothes. The fashion conscious are helped to dress for that one-off special occasion and dodge a hefty price tag. Top-notch jewellery can be rented from Diamond Thrills and high-end, must-have designer handbags from The Handbag Rental.

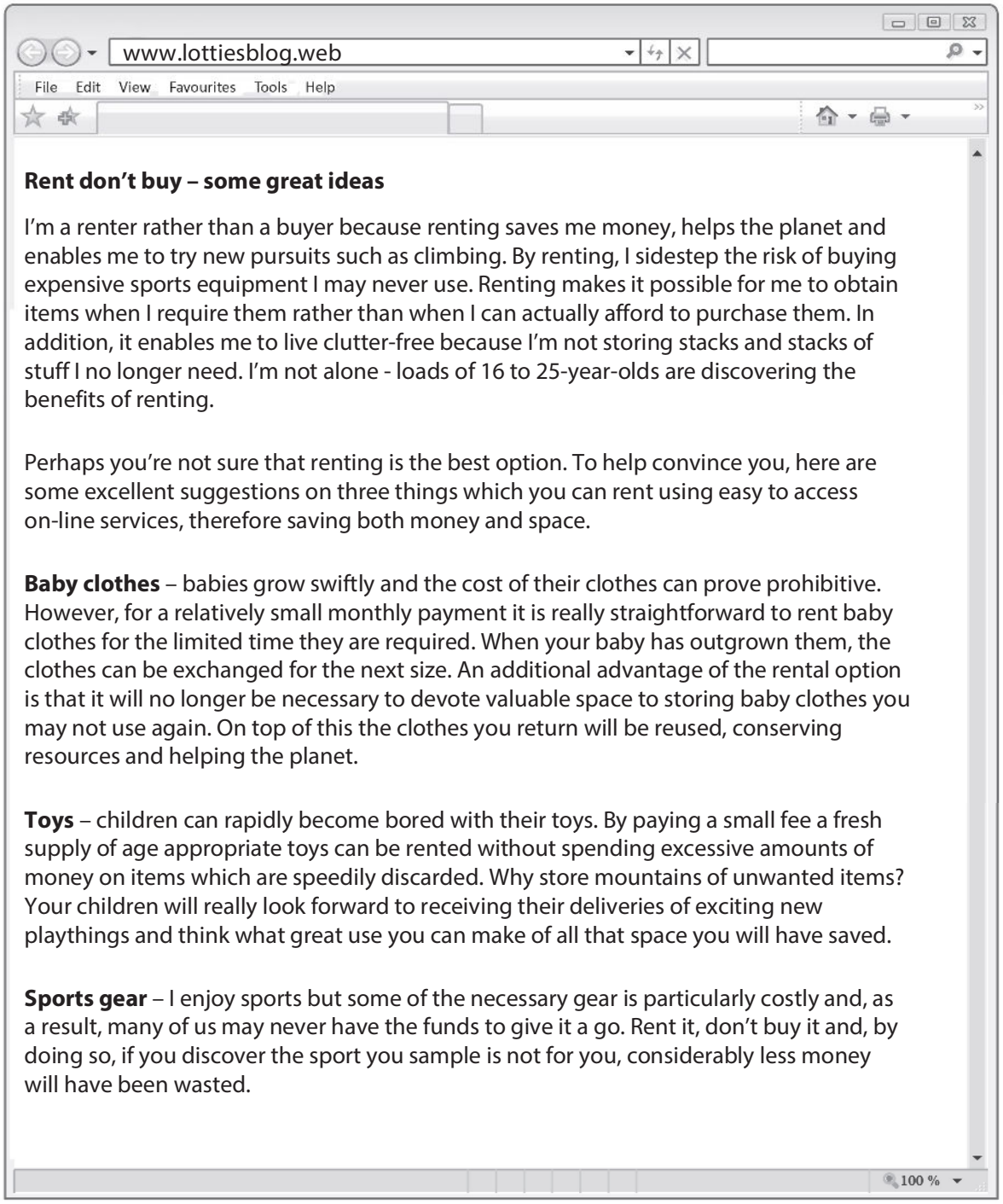
The sharing economy also benefits dog owners. BorrowMyDoggy.com links dog lovers to dog owners so that their dogs can enjoy more regular walks. DogVacay helps owners find their dog a loving home rather than kennels when they go on holiday, which can save them money. Film and music have also seen a massive move away from ownership thanks to streaming sites such as Netflix, Amazon Prime and Spotify. Some people even think that there is no need to own any films or music.

The report found the sharing economy is growing fast. This super-quick growth is helped by rapidly changing attitudes to the ownership of goods. Around 80% of people think that there are many advantages in renting over owning. Two thirds of people who rent wish to live a less materialistic and a more environmentally friendly lifestyle.

Adapted from article by Hannah Parry mailonline.com

**Text C**

**Blog**




**Rent don't buy – some great ideas**

I'm a renter rather than a buyer because renting saves me money, helps the planet and enables me to try new pursuits such as climbing. By renting, I sidestep the risk of buying expensive sports equipment I may never use. Renting makes it possible for me to obtain items when I require them rather than when I can actually afford to purchase them. In addition, it enables me to live clutter-free because I'm not storing stacks and stacks of stuff I no longer need. I'm not alone - loads of 16 to 25-year-olds are discovering the benefits of renting.

Perhaps you're not sure that renting is the best option. To help convince you, here are some excellent suggestions on three things which you can rent using easy to access on-line services, therefore saving both money and space.

**Baby clothes** – babies grow swiftly and the cost of their clothes can prove prohibitive. However, for a relatively small monthly payment it is really straightforward to rent baby clothes for the limited time they are required. When your baby has outgrown them, the clothes can be exchanged for the next size. An additional advantage of the rental option is that it will no longer be necessary to devote valuable space to storing baby clothes you may not use again. On top of this the clothes you return will be reused, conserving resources and helping the planet.

**Toys** – children can rapidly become bored with their toys. By paying a small fee a fresh supply of age appropriate toys can be rented without spending excessive amounts of money on items which are speedily discarded. Why store mountains of unwanted items? Your children will really look forward to receiving their deliveries of exciting new playthings and think what great use you can make of all that space you will have saved.

**Sports gear** – I enjoy sports but some of the necessary gear is particularly costly and, as a result, many of us may never have the funds to give it a go. Rent it, don't buy it and, by doing so, if you discover the sport you sample is not for you, considerably less money will have been wasted.